



Bloatware funda

Android comes pre-loaded with a ton of bloatware like G+, custom UI skins, etc., but why?
<http://dgit.in/BloatWare>

Welcome to the punch

With the situation between Apple and FBI degrading day-by-day, Amnesty International decided to join in along with a few others. <http://dgit.in/InPunch>

Smart SoHo

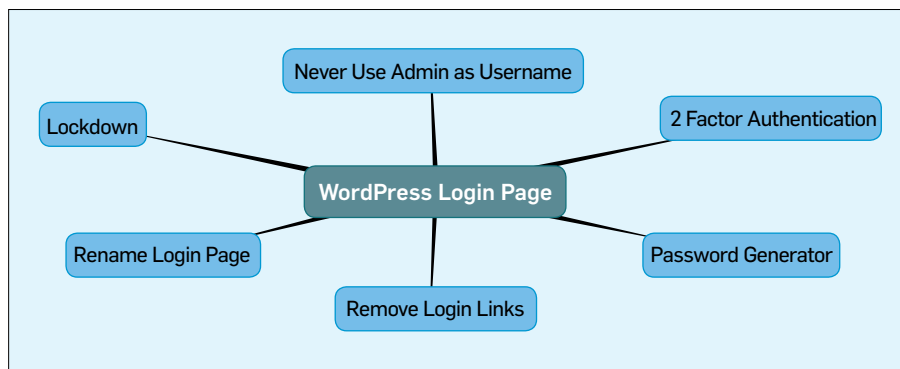
It's all in the directories

When bad guys come knocking at your website's door, they like to try all the popular tricks first to see if your website's unguarded and allows unauthorized access without putting up any fight at all. To dissuade such attack vectors on your website, it's important to make it as difficult as it can be to ensure the assailants can't easily figure out what CMS (content management system) your website runs on (if at all).

If, say, you have a website and online blog running on custom Wordpress installation. Hackers already know that Wordpress is the most popular free CMS and all of them worth their salt are well aware of its source code, installation process and default folder hierarchy on a web server. If you (or your hired webmaster) installs a default instance of Wordpress to run your website and blog, without any intelligent folder structure renaming, hackers can easily guess and scan your website's admin, login and other sensitive pages to gain access at a significantly easy rate.

Nowadays, most sought after CMSes allow renaming of admin and other essential folders within just to frustrate less patient hackers. Picking less obvious, hard to guess and crazy names for your website's admin folders (known only to you and your webmasters) can greatly reduce the chances of any potential successful hack attempts.

In a similar vein, for logging into your website's admin console or dashboard,



Tips for secure WordPress login page

try to avoid using "admin" as a user-name – for the same reason you'd want to change the login URL. Because it's a dead giveaway, making any potential hacker's attempt to break into your website that much more easier.

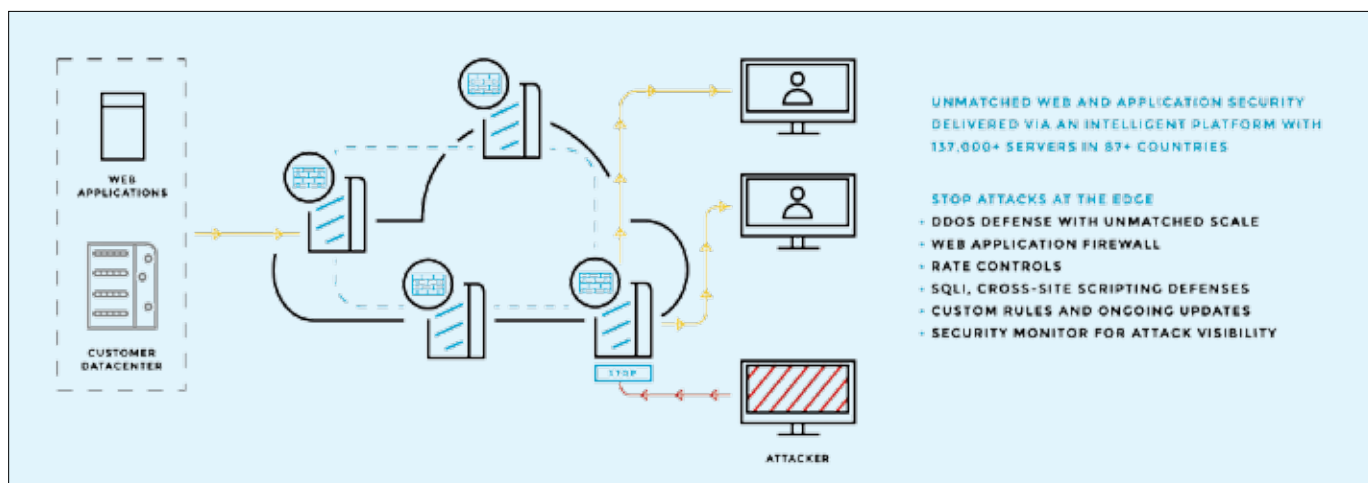
Install a web application firewall (WAF)

Just like you are keen to protect all your digital endpoints – PC, laptop, smartphone, etc. – with a security software (antivirus) of some kind, similarly you need to secure your website, too. Enter WAF or a web application firewall, which is just what the doctor ordered, something that should be a critical component of every online business' security arsenal on a priority basis.

A WAF can be a server plugin or a separate appliance that sits between your web server and incoming / outgoing communication lines, monitoring the traffic that wants to establish a connec-

tion to your website. Essentially what a WAF does is that it defines a strict set of rules when it comes to allowing who gets to connect to your website and who doesn't. It's typically sensitive to sifting through HTTP traffic and keeping an eye out for XSS (cross-site scripting) and SQL injection attacks – some of the most common hack attack vectors – but it can be configured to stay alert and vigilant about more sophisticated attacks as well. Most modern WAF solutions are capable of dealing with DDoS and other advanced potential web threats, too.

WAF can be deployed both at a hardware and software level. Unlike very few popular and reliable PC security vendors, the market for WAF is inundated with a whole bevy of products offering different levels of security. Take a look at Amazon Web Services' WAF offering (<https://aws.amazon.com/waf>) which only debuted in October 2015, and offers web security at an attractive price.



Invest in a security platform for your website to protect it against malicious attacks